Adora's Gone

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/87817026.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Adora's Gone

by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

Adora's gone.

Notes

Shall we?

See the end of the work for more notes

The funeral was over. The private reception was winding down with only a few people left at the house. Catra sat on the back porch in her wheelchair, looking at the backyard she'd designed with Adora decades before when they were young and full of the future. The back part, by the stone wall, had already gone back to the wild years before when they'd both got a little too old to tend to it. Now even the bushes and gardens and grass by the house were a bit ragged. Adora had insisted on keeping the yard up herself, insisting that a little lawn work wouldn't kill her.

She'd been right about that at least.

Catra had thought she'd spend the day crying but she'd been wrong. She'd mostly just been numb. She remembered when Scorpia had died a couple years back, that'd been sudden. No one had seen it coming and the grief had been sharp and close. Adora though, she'd been sick for a long time. Nothing about it had been fast, and the grief that came with it had been slow and grinding. There were moments, in the long decline, when you could almost forget about it and then something would happen and it'd slide over you with the inevitability of a glacier.

Now, at the end of it, she just stared out at the yard.

"Mother?"

Catra didn't turn around at first until she heard Finn come towards her.

"Mother?"

She turned to look at Finn and for a moment was confused. She was thinking of the young child she and Adora had rescued from the streets and the late middle aged person with graying fur and glasses kneeling beside her didn't fit that image for a moment.

"Hey, Finn," Catra finally said and laid a hand on their arm. "You headed home?"

Finn shook their head as they said, "No. I fixed up my room so Izzy and I can stay. The grandkids may stay as well if you don't mind."

Catra thought for a moment Finn meant Catra's grandchildren and then realized they meant their and Izzy's grandchildren. She gave a brief smile that she'd lived to be a great-grandmother. Then the smile snuffed out as she remembered that Adora wasn't there to be one anymore.

"I don't mind," Catra said. "It's your house too, always has been."

"I know," Finn said as they picked Catra's hand up and gave it a brief kiss. "You know I'm always going to ask though."

Finn pulled a chair over and sat down beside Catra and said nothing for a while. Catra remembered when they had been young and would stay silent for hours, occasionally days, at a time. It'd worried her and Adora both at the time but soon they'd figured that Finn would speak when Finn was ready. It hadn't lasted though and she remembered with a smile what a chatterbox they'd become as a teenager.

"Share that thought?" Finn said and Catra startled a little at the sound.

"Was remembering you as a chattering teenager," she replied.

"Chattering, huh?" Finn said with a grin. "Is that how you remember me?"

"Well, you got into theater and that's not exactly a quiet profession," Catra said.

"It worked out for me," Finn said.

Catra thought of the massive theater they ran at Dryl and nodded.

"It did."

She remembered going there on opening night and then she remembered she'd been there with Adora and felt the sadness slide over her again.

"Thinking of Mom?" Finn said gently.

"I'm always thinking of her," Catra said. "Sometimes it's just more on the surface."

"Want to talk about it?"

"Nothing to talk about," Catra said and while she sounded flat, the tears forming in her eyes showed how she felt. "She's gone."

"Not as long as we remember her," Finn said.

Catra let out a little huff of irritation as she said, "Listen, I know people keep saying that but no, she's gone. I can remember all I want but that doesn't put her sitting beside me. She won't be waiting for me when I get home or be able to… damn it!"

Catra furiously wiped at the tears steaming out of her eyes as she looked away from Finn.

"I know," Finn said, their voice sad.

It wasn't the first death she'd lived through. Netossa and Spinnerella had gone within four months of each other about ten years back. Micah was so far back that the pain of his death was just a smooth pebble of a memory now, more ache than sharpness in the remembering. After Scorpia's death, Perfuma went into seclusion and had never come back out. Her funeral had been about a year after Scorpia's. No one knew where Entrapta had gone. There had been no communication from her spaceship in years and it was assumed she drifted among the stars she loved so much. As Catra had gotten older, she'd realized that funerals of her loved ones became more and more common and over the last few years, it'd seemed like they'd never stop and each one hurt. It was Bow that had hurt the most though, at least until Adora.

He'd been the first one other than Adora who'd seemed to care about her. The one who'd been her closest friend other than Adora, who'd always been there for her, who'd seemed to understand her like few did, and when he'd died six months back, she thought she'd never be happy again. She'd wept openly with Glimmer and Adora, not giving a shit who saw or what others thought. She'd spoken at his funeral, tears interrupting her constantly and sworn that the world would never know his like again, that Bow was the most precious of them all and his loss left Etheria dimmer for his passing. She'd thought she couldn't hurt any worse.

Of course, she'd been wrong.

Adora had died in the kitchen. She'd seemed to have been doing better over the last few months and she'd been tottering around the kitchen, ignoring her cane that she'd needed but couldn't stand. Catra had been sitting at their kitchen table, watching some birds outside, when she'd heard Adora try to say something. She'd looked up to see Adora's eyes fixing on her before rolling back a little and collapsing to the ground, bashing into the counter on her way down. Catra had wheeled into the kitchen screaming Adora's name while their live in nurse had come in right behind her. The next few hours didn't really leave a solid print on Catra's mind as it'd simply been a whirl of terror, then numbness, and then grief as the verdict had been given.

Adora, former She-Ra and Princess of Power, had died.

Catra had been surrounded by people ever since then but she had few really close friends left. Glimmer had been with her almost constantly and had only gone home that evening as Finn and Izzy and the rest of Catra's family had settled into the house. The funeral had been enormous, with people from all over Etheria and beyond attending. Catra had hated it. They were there in memory of someone they hadn't really known. The speeches had been about things that had happened decades before. Few talked about Adora as the person Catra had known. Most of them seemed to be talking about a person Catra couldn't even recognize. When it'd

been over, she'd sat in the reception and Glimmer had been more than happy to sit with Catra and have a few of the Bright Moon guards turn away all but a few who came to talk to Catra.

The private reception at the house had been better. It'd been only family and close friends and Catra had felt like those people understood. No one had tried to valorize Adora. They'd told funny stories about her instead and sad stories and just regular stories. The great-grandchildren had listened closely and Catra had done her best to pass on what Adora had been like for them. She could tell they didn't understand, not really, they were still too young but it didn't matter. She had planted a seed and that's all that mattered. Adora would be remembered by the history books a certain way but her descendants would have their own history to carry on, a truer one, at least the way Catra saw it.

Now sitting on the back porch, in the early evening darkness, she thought she saw someone walking across the lawn. Catra smiled and hoped she'd never wake from what she knew was a dream.

"I miss you."

"I know. I'm here to take you home."

"Promise?"

"Promise."

Catra reached out and took Adora's hand.

Finn turned to Catra as they heard her mutter something and saw her slump forward in her chair.

"Mother?"

Finn stepped over to Catra but they already knew. They cried as they hugged her tight, kissed her, and then made the necessary calls.

End Notes

I've been thinking of this for a long time. I originally conceived of this as a series, covering each princess dying with Catra being one of the last but damn, I'm crying pretty hard just from writing this. There's absolutely no way I could have done this over and over. Am I working through some things myself on this? Absolutely. I hope… well, not enjoy, that sounds wrong, but at least find some worth in this story. Thank you for reading.

Also, hey, look! I can still write short fics! :)

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